

PHILADELPHIA ERITREAN
EVANGELICAL CHURCH (PEEC)



BUILDING FAITH & A FUTURE:

Investing in the Future of Eritrean Immigrant
Families and Children in the Columbus Area

DONOR PROPOSAL

PHILADELPHIA ERITREAN EVANGELICAL CHURCH (PEEC)

I know your works. Behold, I have set before you an open door,
which no one is able to shut. I know that you have but little power,
and yet you have kept my word and have not denied my name.

Revelation 3:8

September 2026

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The Philadelphia Eritrean Evangelical Church (PEEC) is a growing, Christ-centered congregation serving over 360 people (adults, youth, and children)—many of whom are survivors of religious persecution, refugee camps, and displacement.

Today, we face a defining moment.

Our church is quickly outgrowing its rented facility. With **55 families, 170 adults, and over 190 youth and children**, we urgently need a permanent home to sustain and expand our ministry. Without it, our ability to disciple the next generation, serve immigrant families, and carry out outreach efforts is limited.

We are launching a campaign to secure a **\$1.5M–\$2M facility**, with a strategic goal to raise **50% down payment (\$750K–\$1M)** to ensure long-term sustainability and minimize financial burden on our working-class congregation with low-paying jobs. PEEC has already raised **\$350K**, demonstrating deep sacrifice and faith in this vision.

Now is the moment to act. Your partnership can help secure a permanent home for a community that has already sacrificed so much. Partner with us in building more than a structure—a **permanent spiritual home that will impact generations**.



Create a lasting legacy by supporting PEEC's vision for a "Hub of Hope."

WHO WE ARE: FAITH TESTED BY FIRE

PEEC was planted in 2010 by Eritrean evangelical believers who fled severe religious and political persecution. Under the harsh Eritrean regime, many evangelicals were imprisoned for their faith, with some prominent pastors enduring over **25 years in prison** simply for preaching the Gospel. Many in our congregation personally experienced imprisonment, forced labor, and years in refugee camps—trials that forged a resilient and deeply rooted faith.

When they arrived in the United States, they sought more than safety—they sought **a place to worship freely and belong**. For our community, the freedom to gather in worship is not taken for granted—it is a **sacred responsibility** and a gift we carry with gratitude and purpose.

What began as a small gathering in the living rooms of devoted members—marked by prayer, worship, and shared hope—has grown into a vibrant and united church family. Today:

- Over **360 members** call PEEC home.
- Families continue to grow, both in number and in faith.
- **Children and youth are the fastest-growing part of our church**, representing the future we are called to nurture.
- This journey is a testimony to God’s faithfulness—transforming hardship into hope and building a community rooted in faith, resilience, and love.



Some of the PEEC Church Family



Building Friendships Through Outdoor Fellowship Activities

Our mission and leadership:

- **Core Church Mission:** PEEC exists to raise generations grounded in Christ, strengthened in community, and equipped to serve through worship, discipleship, prayer, outreach, and family ministry.
- **Statement of Faith:** Our commitment to sound doctrine and the transformative power of the Gospel.
- **Leadership:** Led by Pastor Negga Weldesemait and a committed leadership team.



Some of the children in our congregation with their teachers



A special time of prayer for our children and their future

STORIES OF FAITH, SACRIFICE, AND LEADERSHIP

Behind PEEC stands a community shaped by sacrifice, where stories of faith and perseverance are not the exception, but the foundation.



Pastor Negga Weldesemait wholeheartedly served the Lord since his youth, planting churches among Eritrean and Ethiopian communities across multiple countries, often with little to no resources. He now leads PEEC, models Christ-like love, and raises his three children alongside his wife.



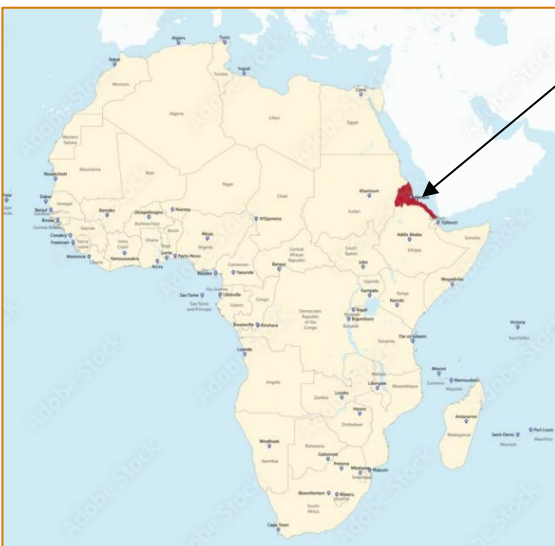
Pastor Mulugeta Mengisteab faithfully planted and led churches among Eritrean refugees, serving full-time for 7+ years without pay. Now he leads the teaching and preaching ministry of PEEC and oversees the Titus Ministry. Pastor Mulugeta, his wife, and their six children exemplify a life of sacrificial devotion to Christ.



Brother Amanuel Tsadik spent 3+ years in Eritrea's notorious Me'eter desert prison, where believers were held in metal shipping containers under extreme 125°F heat. He now serves as a church leader and hosts the Gospel radio and podcast ministry, *Voice of Selamna*, sharing God's Word with the Eritrean people alongside his wife and two children.

These are not just leaders—they are living testimonies of **faith, sacrifice, and resilience**.

These stories are not isolated examples. They represent a much broader reality within PEEC. Many members carry similar stories of persecution, sacrifice, and unwavering faith. What you see here is only a glimpse of a community shaped by resilience and devotion.



Facts about Eritrea

- **Location:** Eritrea is a country in the Horn of Africa along the Red Sea, bordering Sudan, Ethiopia, and Djibouti.
- **Capital:** The capital and largest city is Asmara.
- **Population:** Approximately 3.5–6 million people, with diverse ethnic groups such as Tigrinya and Tigre.
- **History:** Eritrea gained independence in 1993 after a 30-year war with Ethiopia.

PEEC'S TITUS MINISTRY: A LIFELINE ACROSS BORDERS

PEEC's Titus Ministry is more than an outreach effort—it is a deeply personal mission rooted in shared experience, compassion, and unwavering faith.

Our congregation includes men and women who once fled the very conditions now faced by Eritrean refugees in Ethiopia and Sudan, and those persecuted because of their faith in Christ. They know what it means to live without stability, to lack basic necessities, and to depend on the kindness of others. And because they remember, they respond.

- **Deeply Personal Mission**

- Led by members who were once refugees themselves and Rooted in shared experience, compassion, and faith

- **Sacrificial Giving**

- Working-class families give consistently despite limited means
- Support includes emergency aid and food for refugees in Ethiopia and Sudan

- **Current Constraints**

- Donations stored across garages, basements, and homes
- Limited space leads to inefficiencies and fragmented operations

- **Opportunity with a Permanent Facility**

- Centralized storage and distribution hub
- Greater efficiency, scale, and coordination
- Expanded outreach and impact

- **Faith in Action**

- Reflects biblical call to serve others:

“Let our people learn to devote themselves to good works... to help cases of urgent need.” Titus 3:14

- **Why It Matters**

- Bridges past and present → those once helped now helping others
- Transforms scattered generosity into a unified **hub of hope**



PEEC'S TITUS MINISTRY: A LIFELINE ACROSS BORDERS



HUMANITARIAN
AID



ERITREAN
REFUGEES



SACRIFICIAL

A GLIMPSE AT OUR CHILDREN AND YOUTH MINISTRY



Nurturing Our Youngest Learners: Pre-K to Grade 1 students building a strong foundation in faith, character, and early learning.



Growing in Knowledge and Faith: Grades 2 to 3 students developing biblical understanding, friendships, and a love for learning.



Equipping Future Leaders: *Grades 4 to 6 students strengthening their faith, expanding their knowledge, and preparing to serve others.*



Preparing the Next Generation: *Grades 7 and above engaging in deeper discipleship, leadership development, and Christian fellowship.*

CELEBRATING TOGETHER AND SUPPORTING ONE ANOTHER IN TIMES OF LOSS

Another important reason we need a permanent place to call our own is to have a space where we can gather as a church family to celebrate significant life events and support one another during difficult times. In Eritrean culture, many life events are traditionally celebrated and observed at the community level, and PEEC continues this practice.

1. Celebrations and Milestones

It is our tradition to celebrate important milestones such as weddings, anniversaries, and high school and college graduations as a church community. These events are typically held at our church facility, allowing the congregation to share in the joy of those being honored. Such gatherings encourage younger generations by providing positive examples to follow, while also strengthening fellowship, unity, and relationships among church members.



Celebrating Academic Achievement: *Honoring our high school and college graduates as they reach important milestones and prepare for the next chapter of their journey.*



Rejoicing in God's Faithfulness: *Church members gathering in worship and thanksgiving, celebrating special occasions and praising the Lord for His blessings and guidance.*

2. Mourning and Bereavement Support

We also come together as a congregation during times of loss. When a loved one passes away, members of the church gather for three to seven days to comfort the grieving family, share words of encouragement, pray together, and provide emotional and spiritual support. These gatherings are an important expression of our faith, compassion, and commitment to caring for one another as a church family.



Providing Comfort Through Prayer: *Pastor Mulugeta praying with a grieving family, reflecting our commitment to spiritual care and support during times of loss.*



Walking Together Through Times of Grief: *Church members gathering to comfort and encourage a bereaved family, demonstrating Christ's love through fellowship, prayer, and compassionate presence.*

THE URGENT NEED: A CRISIS OF GROWTH

God has blessed PEEC with remarkable growth. While we are deeply grateful for our partnership with The Cross Walk Church in Reynoldsburg, which has graciously hosted us since 2016, our current space is no longer sufficient to support the increasing demands of our growing congregation and expanding ministries.

Current Challenges

- **Limited space** restricts effective worship, teaching, and community events
- **190+ youth and children** lack adequate classroom space
- **Scheduling restrictions** hinder ministry growth
- **Outreach efforts** are constrained by lack of space
- **Titus Ministry supplies** are stored in members' garages

The Reality

Our congregation is doing everything it can—but **we have surpassed the limits of what renting can provide.**

Without a permanent facility:

- We risk stalling our growth
- We limit the development of our youth
- We reduce our ability to serve the broader community



Children Dressed in Festive Attire for Christmas Celebration



Resurrection Sunday in Traditional Eritrean Clothing



Prayer for the New School Year: *Praying for our children before the start of a new school year, asking for God's guidance and protection.*

THE VISION: A MULTIPURPOSE “HUB OF HOPE”

We are trusting God to establish a permanent facility that will serve as a **spiritual, cultural, and community center**.

This facility will include:

1. A Sacred Space for Worship

- 350–450 seat sanctuary
- 24/7 access for prayer, services, fellowship, and community events

2. A Legacy for the Next Generation

- Dedicated classrooms for children and youth
- Discipleship space for over **190+ youth and children**

3. A Cultural Bridge

- Venue for weddings, mourning, funerals, and community gatherings
- Preserving Eritrean traditions and identity

4. A Launchpad for Mercy

- Central hub for the **Titus Ministry**, which is crucial for storage and distribution efforts for refugee aid to Ethiopia and Sudan

5. A Community Resource

- Space to support other small congregations
- Outreach programs for immigrant families

ESTABLISH A PERMANENT FACILITY THAT WILL SERVE AS A SPIRITUAL,



**A SACRED
SPACE
FOR WORSHIP**



**A LEGACY
FOR THE NEXT
GENERATION**



**A CULTURAL
BRIDGE**



**A LAUNCHPAD
FOR MERCY**



**A COMMUNITY
RESOURCE**

3-YEAR VISION PLAN: BUILDING A “HOME FOR HOPE”

GOALS: Secure a multipurpose facility (\$1.5M–\$2M) with sustainable 50% down payment.

Year 1 – Foundation & Momentum

- Build internal giving and demonstrate commitment
- Establish donor infrastructure and outreach channels
- Begin partnerships with local churches and supporters

Year 2 – Expansion & Stewardship *[our current stage]*

- Reach the 50% down payment milestone
- Launch targeted campaigns (e.g., children & youth sponsorships)
- Engage major donors and begin active property search

Year 3 – Acquisition & Launch

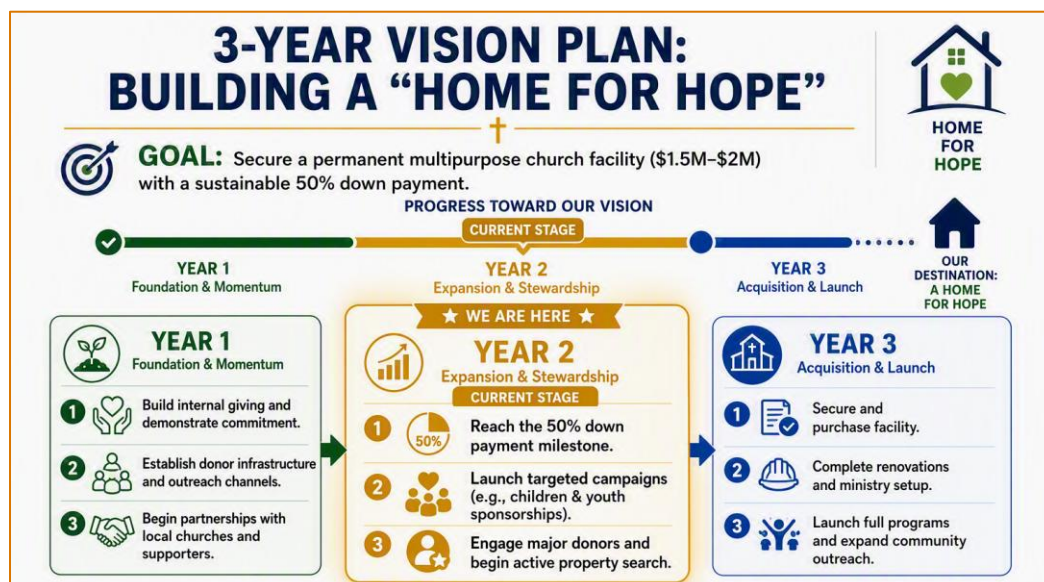
- Secure and purchase facility
- Complete renovations and ministry setup
- Launch full programs and expand community outreach

Why Now

Secure a property within the next 12–18 months as market conditions continue to tighten.

Outcome

A debt-conscious facility to strengthen families, youth, children, and outreach efforts.



PROOF OF COMMITMENT: A FOUNDATION OF SACRIFICE

Our congregation has already demonstrated extraordinary commitment:

- **\$200,000** raised through faithful tithes
- **\$120,000** pledged for long-term giving
- **\$30,000** raised through community fundraising sale of Eritrean traditional food



These contributions come from hardworking families with limited incomes—yet they give sacrificially because they believe in this vision with unwavering faith. Even with modest means, PEEC members remain committed to building a permanent house of worship and community center—a lasting legacy for their children and generations to come.

We are not asking others to invest in what we have not already invested in ourselves.



PEEC women faithfully contribute to the church building vision through fundraising events featuring traditional Eritrean cuisine.

- We would be honored to partner with your church by organizing a Cultural Integration Day, where we can serve your congregation authentic Eritrean cuisine while sharing our story and mission. Proceeds from this event will directly support PEEC's efforts to secure a permanent church home.
- If you are interested, please let us know—our dedicated team will gladly prepare and serve a memorable and meaningful experience for your congregation.

INVESTMENT GOAL & STEWARDSHIP STRATEGY

Project Goal

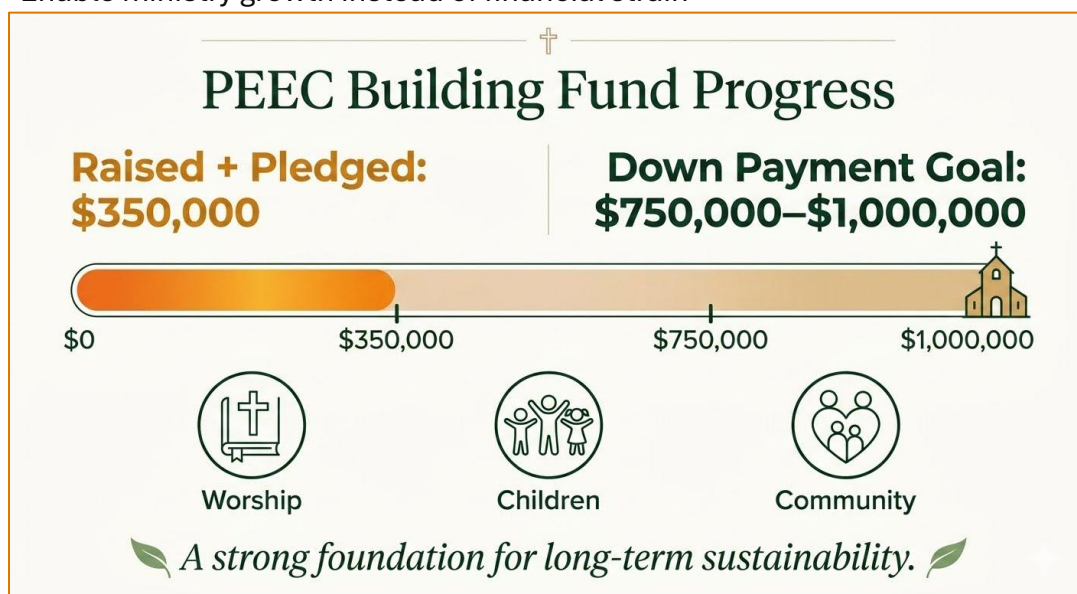
- **Facility Value: \$1.5M – \$2M**
 - Reflects current market conditions in the Columbus area, where rising property values and limited inventory make timely acquisition strategic and necessary

Strategic Financial Approach

- **Raise 50% down payment: \$750K–\$1M**
 - This milestone significantly reduces long-term financial burden and positions the church for sustainable growth from the outset
- **Maintain manageable mortgage obligations**
 - Ensures that ongoing financial commitments remain within the means of our working-class congregation
- **Prioritize ministry over debt service**
 - Allows resources to be directed toward worship, discipleship, youth development, and outreach—rather than being consumed by financial strain
- **Promote long-term financial stability**
 - Establishes a responsible, stewardship-driven foundation that protects the church’s mission for future generations

Your investment will:

- Multiply impact without overburdening a vulnerable community
- Establish long-term sustainability
- Enable ministry growth instead of financial strain



MAJOR DONOR STRATEGY: BUILDING THE FOUNDATION

We are pursuing a focused **lead donor strategy** to build early momentum.

Leadership Giving Opportunity

- We are seeking 10–20 lead partners—along with other committed donors:
 - **Leadership Giving (\$25,000+):**
 - **Vision Partners:** \$100,000+
 - **Foundation Builders:** \$50,000–\$99,999
 - **Cornerstone Donors:** \$25,000–\$49,999
 - **Additional Giving Opportunities:**
 - **\$10,000–\$24,999:** Mid-level donors (Donor Wall recognition)
 - **Below \$10,000:** General contributors
- These gifts will accelerate progress toward the **\$750K–\$1M down payment**, inspire wider giving, and build confidence in the project.

Why It Matters

- A small number of leadership gifts will shape the timeline and success of this project—positioning PEEC for strong, sustainable ownership.

Recognition & Legacy Opportunities

- Donors will have the opportunity to create a lasting legacy through:
 - **Named spaces (for major gifts)** such as the sanctuary, classrooms, and ministry areas
 - **\$25,000+:** Prominent recognition with enhanced naming legacy opportunities
 - **Donor Recognition Wall**, including:
 - **\$10,000–\$24,999:** Name listed on donor wall

Join Us

PEEC has already raised **\$350,000**, demonstrating deep sacrifice and faith.

Your leadership gift can help establish a permanent “Hub of Hope” for generations.

KINGDOM IMPACT: WHY YOUR SUPPORT MATTERS

This project is not just about a building.

Your Giving Will:

- Discipleship **190+ children and youth**
- Strengthen immigrant families
- Preserve faith across generations
- Expand refugee aid efforts internationally
- Create a lasting spiritual home for future believers

Today's investment becomes tomorrow's transformation.

WAYS TO PARTNER

We invite you to join this mission through:

Financial Giving

- **Seed Gifts (\$1,000–\$25,000)** – Immediate impact
- **Major Gifts (\$25,000+)** – Leadership-level investment
- **Legacy Sponsorships (\$2,500–\$10,000)** – Equip youth and children's spaces

Church Partnerships

- Mission-based giving
- Long-term collaboration
- Facility-sharing opportunities

In-Kind Support

- Chairs, equipment, materials

Prayer & Advocacy

- Spiritual covering
 - Stand with us in prayer for God's guidance, provision, and favor
- Donor connections and referrals
 - Share this vision with your church, network, mission-minded donors, and potential supporters who may be led to partner with PEEC

Your donation can help connect this vision to those who are called to be part of it.

HOW TO GIVE

Your generosity can help PEEC establish a permanent home where worship, discipleship, youth development, community outreach, and compassionate care can flourish for generations to come.

Mail Check To:

PHILADELPHIA ERITREAN EVANGELICAL CHURCH
751 Rosehill Road, Reynoldsburg, OH 43068

Online Giving:
(Scan this QR code)



<https://givealittle.co/c/philadelphiachurch>

Zelle / Mobile Giving: Use this dedicated email: **fundpeec2023@gmail.com**

Tax Status:

PEEC is a registered **501(c)(3)** nonprofit organization. *Donations are tax-deductible to the extent allowed by law.* Donation receipts can be provided upon request.

EIN: **46-1557373.**

Major Gifts and Partnerships: If you are interested in making a significant contribution, sponsoring a portion of the project, establishing a matching gift opportunity, or discussing other partnership options, we would be honored to speak with you personally.

Every gift, whether large or small, brings us one step closer to creating a permanent Home for Hope where faith grows, families thrive, and lives are transformed.

CONTACT

Pastor Negga Weldesemaet

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Website: www.peechurch.org

FINAL VISION & CALL TO PARTNERSHIP

We believe this is a God-ordained moment. We are not simply building a church—we are building a Christ-centered home where faith takes root, families flourish, and lives are transformed. This facility will become a place where immigrant families find stability, children are nurtured in truth, and those who once felt displaced discover a true and lasting sense of belonging.

- **Building for Future Generations:** We are establishing a spiritual home where children, youth, and families can grow in Christ—strengthening not only this generation, but generations to come.
- **More Than a Building:** This is not just a building project. It is an investment in ministry, discipleship, outreach, and transforming lives within and beyond our community.
- **A Place to Belong:** PEEC is creating a welcoming and permanent home where individuals and families can worship freely, build meaningful relationships, and grow together in faith.
- **A Legacy of Faith:** What is built today through sacrifice and generosity will become a lasting inheritance—impacting lives, strengthening families, and advancing the Gospel for generations.

We invite you to prayerfully consider partnering with us in this vision. Your support will not only help build a facility—it will help build a future. We ask you to prayerfully consider:

- Making a generous financial contribution
- Partnering with us as a ministry
- Helping us share this vision with others

Together, we are building a legacy of faith, hope, and lasting impact.

“Unless the Lord builds the house, they labor in vain who build it.” — Psalm 127:1



THANK YOU!

Your support today is helping build a brighter future for our children and families. We are truly grateful for your partnership in creating a space where we can grow spiritually, preserve our heritage, and thrive together as one family in Christ.

And my God will meet all your needs according to the riches of his glory in Christ Jesus. Philippians 4:19

PEEC'S SHORT STATEMENT OF FAITH

PEEC is a non-denominational church, prioritizing the foundations of the Christian faith.

- **The Bible:** The infallible, inerrant Word of God and our final authority for faith and life.
- **The Trinity:** One eternal God existing in three equal, divine persons: Father, Son, and Holy Spirit.
- **God:** An infinite, unchangeable Spirit perfect in wisdom, power, holiness, justice, and truth.
- **Jesus Christ:** Truly God and man, born of a virgin, who died for sins, rose again, and will return in glory.
- **The Holy Spirit:** One in substance with the Father and Son, dwelling in believers to grant new life and holiness.
- **Creation:** God created all things from nothing by His word and continues to govern all His creatures.
- **Man:** Created in God's image but fallen through Adam's sin into a state of moral corruption and death.
- **Atonement:** Reconciliation through Christ's substitutionary death, imputing His righteousness to all who repent and trust Him.
- **Holy Communion:** A sacred memorial of Christ's sacrifice, where believers partake in the bread and the cup in remembrance of His body and blood until He returns.
- **Baptism:** We believe in adult baptism as an outward sign of an inward faith and a public declaration of one's commitment to Christ.
- **The Law:** God's moral law perfectly reflects His character and forever binds all people.
- **The Church:** A visible body called to preach the Gospel and administer sacraments under Scriptural authority.
- **Unity in Christ:** We love and welcome all who love the Lord Jesus Christ, embracing every believer regardless of ethnic background or language differences.
- **Culture:** We apply God's commands to our surroundings, defending the sanctity of life and biblical marriage.